

**Regular Meeting  
Monday, January 7, 2019  
Medford School Committee  
Council Chambers**

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mr. Ruggiero, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Edouard-Vincent, Assistant Superintendent of Finance Ms. Patterson, and High School student representative Jasper Su.

Mayor Burke – Called meeting to order at 7:12 PM, Secretary please call the roll.

Attendance – 7 – present 0 – absent

Approval of Minutes of December 17, 2018 - Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion passes.

Report of Secretary - Ms. Kreatz read a report on invoices related to heating and ongoing work that is being done. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Report of Committees - seeing none  
Community Participation - seeing none

Ms. Kreatz - Motion to take the resolution at very end out of order, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Syrah McGivern of 63 Watervale Road, Medford - The Roberts School is applying for a Safe Routes to School grant. Mayor Burke - Walk Boston did a safety audit. Once this is approved it would be taken over by MassDOT. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto. The School Committee will circulate a copy of the letter for signatures.

Roll call vote - 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes.

Motion to revert to regular order offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion carries.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Happy New Year. CCSR Le Club Glou Glou created Thanksgiving baskets for fifteen (15) Medford High families. It was an oversight that I didn't mention it earlier. Nouha Elyazid, CCSR student and sophomore at Medford High, did a toy drive, over 50 toys collected for Franciscan Children's Hospital. Thank you.

Medford High School's Transitional Program hosted a holiday gathering along with Malden High School's Transitional Program. Getting them together was one of the best social opportunities students have had. Special thanks to Headmaster Paul D'Alleva.

I would like to acknowledge Medford High's AP and Honors calculus class. Ms. Chyen's class worked on creating a 3D model to communicate a mathematical problem and it's calculus solution in a shadow box. Excellent work. Photos are posted on the MPS blog.

Since the last time we met we had a wonderful ceremony swearing in our new Police Chief John Buckley. Our Medford High School string ensemble provided the musical selections for the ceremony. We at Medford Public Schools welcome him aboard.

Tufts University is a partner, they will be hosting the Tufts Classic at Cousin's Gym, January 20th at 12:30 PM and 2 PM. Our boys and girls basketball teams will play Somerville teams and each team that wins will take home the Tufts Cup. Come out and support our teams. No fee but bring a non-perishable food item.

My entry plan involves math improvement. We work with Lesley University to address elementary math performance. We want to continue to make meaningful math partnerships. Conversations about early childhood mathematics make math come alive at the youngest levels so it carries through to high school. We are in the process of scheduling our second math instructional learning rounds. We will schedule them for the end of January, going deeper in each school. That work is continuing.

Facilities: Caron theater heating coil was replaced so it is now fixed. Buildings and Grounds are still working and making progress on the heat in the gymnasium.

I had the opportunity to observe instruction with Headmaster Paul D'Alleva. We visited a carpentry classroom today and saw a beautiful table being sanded by a student. Students in carpentry will be constructing bed frames for refugee children through the Boston Cares Foundation. We are working hard to make a difference in the lives of our community but also in the lives of the greater community. The wood has been delivered and I will keep you posted on

the work done there. We also observed a metalfab classroom where students were making steel roses, they were beautiful. The students are excited about the work that's happening there. I will continue to be in classrooms and look at instruction on all levels.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Carpentry has made bed frames for homeless families because when you are housed you're not allowed to move in until you have a bed for every child. Motion to receive the Superintendent's Report and place on file by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Mustone, motion carries.

Dr. Randi Schuster - Technical delay.

Motion to take papers 5 and 6 out of order by Ms. Mustone, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Lueders Environmental donation of \$125 - Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero.

Roll call vote, 7 in the affirmative, 0 in the negative, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Statute for Joint City/School Director of Security Position - Mayor Burke - We have a placeholder for this position in the budget. They oversee all security for the city and schools. We have posted the job and interviews will begin next week. We would like them to implement the changes from the Safe Havens report. Ms. Van der Kloot - What is the salary range? Mayor Burke - We will send that to you. Ms. Van der Kloot - Where will the person be housed? Mayor Burke - City Hall for now. Mr. Ruseau - Will there be any additional staff for this person? Mayor Burke - No, the person will be supported by our office. This person would be the one to coordinate activities. Person would be on the road a lot. Ms. DiBenedetto - Who will actually hire and oversee this person? Mayor Burke - It is joint funded. It will be an appointment of my office and Kirsteen will be sitting on interviews. I will make the appointment. Ms. DiBenedetto - Will school security staff report to this person? Mayor Burke - That is being hammered out. Ms. Mustone - Can a school resource officer do this? Mayor Burke - It is more comprehensive than that. We looked at different avenues and it made sense to have a standalone independent person. Ms. Van der Kloot - Can we sit in on interviews? Mayor Burke - This is an administrative appointment, not school committee. Mr. Ruseau - We have not approved active-shooter ALICE training, right? Mayor Burke - Right. Mr. Ruggiero - Will this new person report directly to you and act independently? What will the relationship be between the new person and the Superintendent? Mayor Burke - They will work closely. Ms. Mustone - I was surprised to see this on the agenda because we haven't discussed it since May. Can it be a one-year contract? Because the cost of payroll is high, I would rather pay for more math coaches.

Can it be a one year job to just implement what we got from Safe Havens? Mayor Burke - It is ongoing, implementation will not be a one-year project. Motion to approve by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kretz.

Roll call vote, 6 in the affirmative, 1 in the negative, motion passes.

Motion to revert to regular business by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau, motion passes.

Informational report on Vaping and Cannabis - Dr. Randi Schuster - This presentation discusses the impact of early drug exposure on the developing brain. We have done a good job getting kids off cigarettes but marijuana is on the rise. States are legalizing marijuana more and more for medical and recreational purposes. Other states require opt-ins for recreational marijuana. In Massachusetts you have to opt-out. Medford had a moratorium but it expired. A minimum of 3 shops will open in Medford because the city voted in the affirmative for recreational marijuana. In order to move backwards on that we would need a special election so this will become reality. Most importantly, the potency of THC has increased significantly. Dabs are cannabis concentrates, highly potent substance concentrated to an oil or wax you can vape. Dabs will not cause an odor or make eyes red, but products can be 95% THC. It's a different drug. Mr. Ruggiero - Can vaping detectors detect this? Dr. Schuster - It creates a water vapor. We don't know how this level of THC is affecting developing brains. In Massachusetts we can't put restrictions on high potency products. We have to approach the conversation with nuance.

Adolescent use is more dangerous because the brain is not fully developed until age 25. The last region to develop is the prefrontal cortex, decision making, attention, memory, impulse control, risk taking. Cannabis affects portions of the brain still developing in adolescence.

Is cannabis addictive? Yes, for some. The addiction rate doubles when begun in adolescence. Marijuana use has a strong association with psychosis, depression and anxiety, bipolar disorder, suicide, and lower IQ. Cognitive difficulties increase if user began using when younger. Takeaway is that the younger a child is when they begin using marijuana the worse the effects are. Harm reduction, rather than abstinence, is the goal because of legalization. More palatable message is "this might be okay but not right now."

Mr. Ruggiero - Is it reversible? Dr. Schuster - We have preliminary data that says that yes it is reversible quickly. And people perform much better cognitively when they are not using marijuana. Some people have greater negative outcomes, if they have a history of mental health issues, ADHD. Prevention will be greatest benefit. Tailored, targeted prevention messages to kids most vulnerable.

Dr. Schuster - Vaping is a public health crisis and an epidemic. We don't have much data about effects of e-cigarette use on the brain, but we know they are marketed towards adolescents. We have seen a 2x increase in rate of use since last year. Users may think they're vaping just flavoring are actually vaping nicotine. Kids who vape nicotine are more likely to use marijuana or cigarettes. It's concerning especially given that cigarette use is at an all-time low. Each Juul cartridge contains the same amount of nicotine as a pack of cigarettes. When a person is exposed to nicotine, other drugs become more potent.

Although cannabis may have medical properties for some users and e-cigarettes may be a safer alternative than cigarettes for adults, the adolescent brain is vulnerable and we know little about the use of products on developing brain and this requires smart prevention messages as access will increase.

Ms. Kreatz - What are we doing at our schools? Ms. Wray - We will address your questions.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you for being here. Ms. DiBenedetto - Thank you. Can we share this in parent education forums? We should have a strict policy in place to help students make better choices. I would like to have a committee focus on our role, a subcommittee? Mr. Ruggiero - Vaping of cannabis oils, do we have a sense of that increase? Dr. Schuster - Vaping nicotine is more common, cannabis is more stigmatized, but the level of THC exposure is concerning because we have no data. Mr. Ruggiero - Do we have a sense of how it is increasing? Dr. Schuster - No, because it's very new.

Jasper Su - Major increase in nicotine vaping products in school especially this past year. Influence of media. Being a cool kid. There is negative feedback on people who don't use vape pens. There are bathrooms I won't use anymore. It's pretty bad. It wasn't like this when I started. It's even in 5th grade. It's a big problem.

Ms. Mustone - Do you know of a better curriculum updated with these new concerns? Ms. Wray - We will address this. Dr. Schuster - What I have seen work well is having students like Jasper talk about it. Engaging in dialogue, problem solving, laying out pros and cons. Messages are more powerful when they come from students themselves.

Medford Board of Health Report on Vaping response in Medford - Penny Funairole, MaryAnn O'Connor, Lisa Bandoian - Vaping being a "safer alternative" is up for debate. The FDA does not approve these devices like the nicotine patch. The state tobacco 21 law went into effect January 1st, so the age to purchase any nicotine product is now 21. Medford tobacco laws are strictly 21 plus, there are lots of regulations around prices, locations near schools, we have

capped the number of stores at 5, and we have updated the public places smoking prohibition to include e-cigarettes.

CBD is supposed to not have THC but it's not regulated so the Board of Health has restricted all CBD to 21+ stores.

Medford smoking enforcement - police can ticket people for smoking violations at rates of \$100 and up. We expect the rate of use in our 2019 survey to explode since the latest data was available (2017). We have updated the questions about vaping for the student survey for this year. Would they still use e-cigarettes if they were not able to use flavors? How are they using it?

We are working with community-based policing policies to think about how to do diversion instead of criminal justice. If they are caught, they get a fine, and the fine can be waived if they participate in a diversion program: Medford ASAP. It's a great program but police are not finding people using because they don't do it in parks, they do it at home.

Mayor Burke - Is the school resource officer aware of this program? Ms. Funairole - We are working on integrating all aspects of policing and diversion. Belmont and Georgetown have specific vaping diversion programs we can learn from. Ms. DiBenedetto - Do we need to set policy so they are required to do the program? Mayor Burke - An officer can give a ticket in any public building. Ms. DiBenedetto - We should require students who are caught vaping to attend the program. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We have a strict policy in place in the schools. There are Saturday detentions, social probation. There are structures in place but students are savvy about concealing so it's tough to catch them.

Motion to create a committee to look into this further offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Mr. Ruseau - Is there any evidence that punishment has an effect on use? Ms. O'Connor - No. Education seems to be the solution. Ms. Funairole - We are attacking it on multiple levels with universal education, getting users off, and getting recovery resources for people who need it.

Maureen Busby - Medford Tobacco Prevention Coordinator - I would have said kids get e-cigarettes from older kids. I have recently gotten complaints everywhere that stores are selling to minors. They are popular products, relatively expensive, so stores are now selling to youth. We are lining up trained youth to do compliance checks. This is a brand new complaint. We did flavor restrictions and they switched to menthol. In this retail environment we need higher penalties for people who sell to youth.

Ms. O'Connor - The Board of Health agenda on Tuesday includes considerations of further restrictions. We can impose a local sales tax like cigarettes. We can embed vaping specific education and parent education.

Report on MPS Response to Vaping - Rachel Perry - A few years ago we saw vaping coming down the pike. We developed education about vaping for students in grades 9-12. The Michigan Model includes education on vaping. As information comes we are passing it to teachers. We are constantly updating.

Toni Wray - There is a universal lowest level of support, which increases as a student is observed with a higher level of need. SAFE project involves on-site counseling for substance abuse. We are starting early with education on good decision making. We go from a harm reduction model. Motivational interviewing. Providing support and helping students own the responsibility for changing their behavior. We have done programs in the community. We have one coming up in February. Parents will drop off students at a dance and go see a speaker on vaping. Grants as well.

Mr. Ruseau - Have you talked about going back to 5th grade? Ms. Perry - In elementary we cover social emotional learning and DARE. Mr. Ruseau - Does Michigan Model cover it for the younger grades? Ms. Perry - We haven't purchased that part but they do have it. Ms. Van der Kloot - The dance and parent education at the McGlynn Middle school - will it be open to Andrews families? Ms. Wray - Yes. Ms. Van der Kloot - If we are not getting Andrews parents, can we see if we can integrate the dance to include Andrews students? Ms. Wray - Yes.

Motion to take all three reports and place them on file offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Fiscal 2019 Budget Update - Ms. Patterson - This is a summary of our current budget expenditures. Roughly half the year is over and roughly half the budget has been spent. The encumbrance amount goes higher and lower over time, expenditures have materials so that's a true figure. Salaries have 2% cost of living allowance increase, up to date, unit steps have been issued. Security cameras are over but we will do a budget adjustment. Technology updates were done over the summer. Transportation will need to be updated next year. There will be cost savings over the second half of the year. Utilities have had favorable rates so far this year, we budget conservatively. There is a simplified snapshot attached to see what we're spending and where.

Ms. DiBenedetto - Can you explain instructional support staff? Ms. Patterson - The budgets may not reflect reality because of ongoing changes and payroll codes. The person assigned to that

may be coded to another line item. Ms. DiBenedetto - Do Principals know what money they have? They don't hold off on ordering textbooks? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We update them at monthly leadership meetings.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you for taking the step to provide transportation to newcomers in a new way. At this time is there no limit on expenditures? Ms. Patterson - Correct. And if certain categories aren't spent in April or May we notify them. Ms. Van der Kloot - Transition key roles - can you provide school committee with a list of the business office key roles? Mr. Ruseau - I was happy to see technology equipment there. Motion to accept and place on file offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Condolences - John Welch was a wonderful man and touched many.

Motion to adjourn, 9:36 PM.